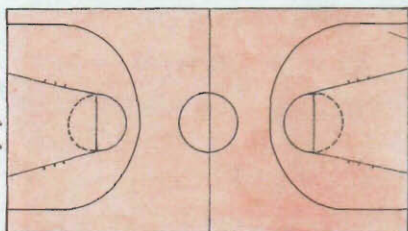


Basketball

A five-a-side game, basketball allows free substitution from as many as seven other players. The aim is to put the ball into the opposition's basket. Baskets, or field goals, are worth three points when scored from outside the three-point line, and two points when scored from inside the line.



Basketball court

A basketball court is 28 m x 15 m (91.8 ft x 49.2 ft). The baskets stand 3.05 m (10 ft) above the ground.

Ball is made of rubber, encased in leather, rubber, or synthetic material.



Basketball

Basket



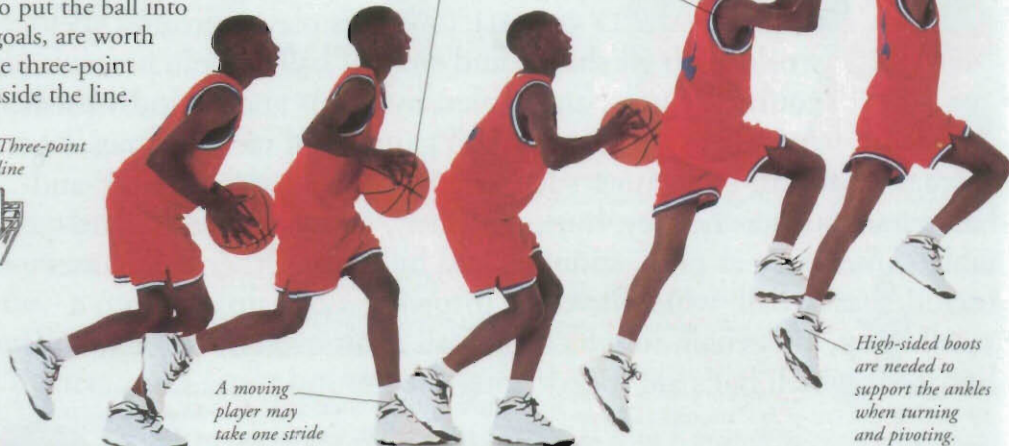
Backboard

Basketball equipment

The main equipment needed for basketball is a ball and two baskets. Official time-keepers use clocks to keep track of the many time restrictions in the game, including the five-second limit on a player holding the ball.

The player holds the ball in both hands when preparing to shoot.

Players can pivot and jump with the ball, as when trying to score a "basket".



A moving player may take one stride with the ball.

High-sided boots are needed to support the ankles when turning and pivoting.

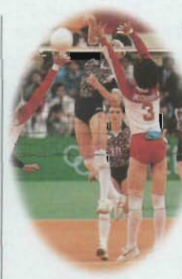
Netball

This seven-a-side game is played by women and girls only. The aim is to throw the ball into the opponents' net. Players must stay in certain areas of the court and may not move with the ball. They wear letters to show where they should be.



Volleyball

Teams of six players aim to score points by propelling the ball over a net into the opponents' court so that they cannot return it. Players can play the ball with their hands or any part of the body above the waist. A team is allowed three touches to hit the ball over the net.



Golf

The aim in golf is to take as few strokes as possible to hit a ball a certain distance into a cup set in the ground. Players have a choice of clubs with which to strike the ball. The standard course has 18 holes of various lengths with different hazards.



Starting a swing to hit the ball

Following through after contact

End of follow-through



Tees

Golf balls

Wood

Iron

Putter

Wood

Iron

Wood

Iron

Wood

Iron

Wood

Iron

Wood

Iron

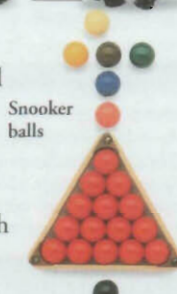
Wood

Iron

Wood

Cue-and-ball games

Games played on billiards and pool tables include snooker and pool. Players use a stick called a cue to propel a white ball on to coloured balls to knock them into a pocket, or pot them. Billiards is played with three balls – one white cue ball for each player and a red ball.



Snooker balls

Pool

Eight-ball is the most widely played variety of pool. To win, one player must pot balls 1 to 7 in any order and then the 8, or black ball. The other player tries to pot balls 9 to 15 and then 8. Players take turns, remaining at the table until they fail to pot a ball, or commit a foul.



Snooker

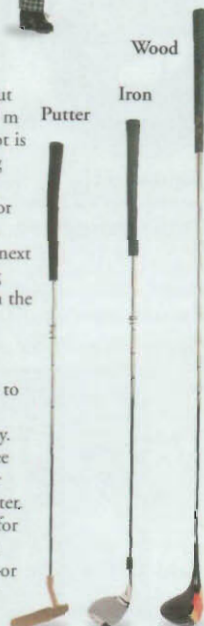
Players pot a red for one point, and then any colour for two to seven points, depending on the colour. The colours are replaced until no reds remain and then potted in order of their value.

Playing a hole

Holes range from about 90 m (100 yd) to 550 m (600 yd). The first shot is played from the teeing ground with either a wood, which is used for long shots, or an iron. Irons are used for the next shots until the putting green is reached, when the putter is used.

Golf equipment

Players are allowed up to 14 clubs, which they carry in a bag or trolley. Most players have three or four woods, nine or ten irons, and one putter. The ball is supported for the first stroke of each hole on a small stand, or tee. Players must wear studded shoes.



Bowls and bowling

Flat-green bowls is played on a flat lawn, or indoors on a carpet. Players roll balls called woods, aiming to get them as close as possible to a smaller white ball called the jack. Tenpin bowling is played on indoor alleys. At each turn, bowlers have two goes to knock down as many pins as possible.



Flat-green wood

Indoor bowls

Jack

Bowling ball

Pins

Equipment

Woods for bowls are weighted on one side so that they curve when rolled. Bowling balls have holes for the thumb and two fingers. The ten pins are cleared and reset automatically.

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